



Scratch Accounts

Set up six weeks out

Do this two to three weeks before week one. Teacher account approval is not instant, and spending session one on signups is the fastest way to lose a room full of children.

The problem with kids signing up themselves

Scratch asks new users for a **parent or guardian's email address**, and the account needs that email confirmed before it can do things like share projects and post comments. For a club running fifteen 8-to-12-year-olds, that means fifteen parents finding fifteen confirmation emails, some of which land in spam, on the evening before your class.

It does not work. Don't try.

The solution: a Scratch Teacher Account

Scratch offers **teacher accounts** designed for exactly this. With one you can:

- Create student accounts in bulk without an individual email address for each child
- Group them into a **class**
- Reset student passwords yourself when they forget — and they will
- See all your students' projects in one place

Request one at scratch.mit.edu/educators. Approval is manual and can take a few days, sometimes longer, so **do not leave this to the last week**. Scratch's own [Teacher Accounts Guide](#) walks through the setup.

Recommended setup

1. Request the teacher account in the **club's** name, not a personal one, with a club email address. The club should outlive any one volunteer.
2. Create a class called something like `Game Makers 2026 T1`.
3. Generate student accounts. Use a naming convention that isn't a full real name — `kcc_amal_r`, `kcc_deepa_m`. First name plus initial is plenty.
4. Set a simple starting password. They can change it later if they want.
5. Print login slips — one small card per student with their username and password. Hand them out in week one and tell them to keep it in their bag. Print spares; several will be lost.

Privacy notes worth being deliberate about

- **Don't use full real names as usernames.** Scratch usernames are public.
- Tell students in week one, and again in week eight, not to put their full name, school, address, or photo in a project.
- Class projects are visible to you as the teacher. Say so — it's honest, and it's a mild deterrent against silliness.

- Mention on the consent form that a Scratch account will be created for their child, and what that means. Parents should not discover this later.

If a teacher account doesn't come through in time

Fallbacks, in order of preference:

1. **Use the club's email for all accounts.** Scratch permits multiple accounts per email address. Clunky, and you'll be forwarding confirmation emails, but it works.
2. **Work without accounts for week one.** Scratch runs fine logged out; students just can't save to the cloud. Have them download their project as an `.sb3` file at the end and email it to you or save it to a USB stick. This is a one-week bridge, not a term-long plan — losing work kills motivation faster than anything else.
3. **Scratch Desktop everywhere.** Projects save locally to the machine. Works with no internet at all, which is useful anyway (see below), but tie each child to one machine or their work goes missing.

Have Scratch Desktop installed regardless

The laptops are the families' own, so you can't pre-install anything. Put the [Scratch Desktop](#) installers for Windows and macOS on a USB stick and offer to install it on each machine in week one. It takes five minutes per laptop, once, and plenty of parents will say yes. Definitely have it on your own presenting laptop.

Community venue wi-fi fails. It will fail on the week you're teaching broadcasts, and it will fail on showcase night. Having the offline editor already installed turns a cancelled session into a mildly inconvenient one.

Pair it with a USB stick: download every student's `.sb3` file at the end of each class as a term-long backup. It takes two minutes and it has saved more than one course.

Week-one account routine

1. Log every machine in **before** students arrive. Do not have children typing passwords in the first ten minutes.
2. Hand out login slips as they sit down.
3. Show them once where **My Stuff** is and how to check a project saved.
4. Teach the save habit immediately: *name your project first, save often, check the name.*

Links

- [Scratch for Educators](#)
- [Scratch Teacher Accounts Guide \(PDF\)](#)
- [Scratch Desktop download](#)
- [Creating an Account — Scratch Wiki](#)